

PSALMS XCIII.—XCV.

4 (But) more than the noise of great waters, than the mighty billows of the sea, is the LORD excellent on high.

5 Thy testimonies are exceedingly steadfast: in thy house abideth holiness,* O LORD! to the utmost length of days.

PSALM XCIV.

1 ¶ O God, of vengeance,^b LORD! O God of vengeance, shine forth.

2 Lift up thyself, O Judge of the earth! bring a recompense upon the proud.

3 How long shall the wicked, O LORD—how long shall the wicked exult?

4 They sputter, they speak hard things: all the workers of wickedness boast themselves.

5 Thy people, O LORD! they crush, and thy heritage they afflict.

6 The widow and the stranger they slay, and the fatherless they murder.

7 And they say, The LORD will not see, and the God of Jacob will not take notice of it.

8 Understand, ye brutish among the people: and ye fools, when will ye become intelligent?

9 He that hath planted the ear, shall he not hear? or he that hath formed the eye, shall he not see?

10 He that admonisheth^c nations, shall he not correct? is it not he that teacheth man knowledge?^d

11 The LORD knoweth the thoughts of man, that they are nought.

12 Happy is the man whom thou admonishest, O LORD, and teachest him out of thy law:

13 That thou mayest grant him repose from the days of evil, until the pit be dug for the wicked.

14 For the LORD will not cast off his people, and his inheritance will he not forsake.

15 For unto righteousness will justice return; and it shall be followed by all the upright in heart.

16 Who will rise up for me against evil-doers? or who will stand forward for me against the workers of wickedness?

17 Unless the LORD had been a help unto me, but a little would have been wanting that my soul had dwelt in the silence of death.

18 When I said, My foot hath slipped: thy kindness, O LORD, sustained me.

19 In the multitude of my (painful) thoughts within me, thy consolations delight my soul.

20 Can there be associated with thee the throne of destructive wickedness, which frameth mischief as^e a law?

21 They band themselves together against the soul of the righteous, and innocent blood do they condemn.

22 But the LORD is become my defence, and my God, the rock of my refuge.

23 And he will bring back upon them their own injustice, and in their own wickedness will he destroy them: (yea,) he will destroy them—the LORD our God.

PSALM XCV.

1 ¶ Oh come, let us sing unto the LORD: let us shout joyfully to the rock of our salvation.

2 Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving, and shout joyfully unto him with psalms.

3 For a great God is the LORD, and a great King above all gods;

4 In whose hand are the deep places of the earth; and whose are the heights of mountains;

5 Whose is the sea, and who hath made it; and whose hands have formed the dry land.

6 Oh come, let us prostrate ourselves and

* Rashi. Redak, "holiness graceth thy house." Others, "becometh thy house."

^b Vengeance in man may be the result of malevolence, because he is subject to passion, and may punish unjustly; hence we are prohibited (Lev. xix. 18) from taking revenge on those who have injured us; but to the Omnipotent belongs properly the prerogative of vengeance; because retribution is the highest prerogative of justice, and this the more in Him who knows all secrets, and is not liable to forgetfulness, and whose very chastisement is mercy.

^c יָרַע generally means "to chastise;" and so do Aben

Ezra and Redak explain it, as having reference to great national calamities like the flood, &c.; but Jonathan renders, "is it possible that he who gave to his people the law should not chastise them when they are guilty?" and hence Philippon, generally, as in our version, "who warneth."

^d Jonathan, Mendelssohn, and others connect this part of verse 10 with verse 11: "he who teacheth man knowledge—the LORD, knoweth," &c.

^e Rashi. Others, "against the law," i. e. of God. The mischief this confederacy of the ugody do is contrary to the divine commands.

PSALMS XCV.—XCVIII.

bow down: let us kneel before the LORD our Maker.

7 For he is our God; and we are the people of his pasture, and the flock of his hand: yea, this day, if ye will hearken to his voice.

8 Harden not your heart, as at Meribah, as on the day of the temptation in the wilderness:

9 When your fathers tempted me, proved me, although they had seen my doing.

10 Forty years long did I feel loathing on that generation, and I said, It is a people of an erring heart; and they truly acknowledged not my ways:

11 So that I swore in my wrath, that they should not enter into my rest.

PSALM XCVI.

1 ¶ Oh sing unto the LORD a new song: sing unto the LORD, all the lands.

2 Sing unto the LORD, bless his name: announce from day to day his salvation.

3 Relate among the nations his honour, among all the people his wonders.

4 For the LORD is great, and greatly praised: he is to be feared above all gods.

5 For all the gods of the nations are idols; but the LORD hath made the heavens.

6 Glory and majesty are before him: strength and beauty are in his sanctuary.

7 Ascribe unto the LORD, O ye families of the people, ascribe unto the LORD honour and strength.

8 Ascribe unto the LORD the honour (due unto) his name: bear hither a present, and come unto his courts.

9 Bow down unto the LORD in the beauty of holiness: tremble before him, all ye lands.

10 Say among the nations, "The LORD reigneth;" (therefore) also the world is ever firmly established that it shall not be moved: he will judge the people in equity.

11 Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad: let the sea roar, with all that filleth it.

12 Let the field exult, and all that is therein: then shall all the trees of the forest sing for joy,

13 Before the LORD; for he cometh, for he cometh to judge the earth: he will judge the world with righteousness, and people in his truth.

PSALM XCVII.

1 ¶ The LORD reigneth: let the earth be glad; let the multitude of isles rejoice.

2 Clouds and thick darkness are round about him: righteousness and justice are the support of his throne.

3 A fire goeth before him, and burneth up round about his adversaries.

4 His lightnings give light to the world: the earth seeth it, and trembleth.

5 The mountains melt away like wax at the presence of the LORD, at the presence of the LORD of all the earth.

6 The heavens tell of his righteousness, and all the people see his glory.

7 Made ashamed shall be all that serve graven images, that boast themselves of idols: unto him bow down all the gods.

8 Zion heareth it, and rejoiceth; and glad are the daughters of Judah, because of thy decrees, O LORD.

9 For thou, O LORD, art the most high above all the earth: thou art greatly exalted above all gods.

10 Ye that love the LORD, hate ye the evil: he preserveth the souls of his pious ones; out of the hand of the wicked he ever delivereth them.

11 Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright in heart,

12 Rejoice, ye righteous, in the LORD, and give thanks to his holy memorial.

PSALM XCVIII.

1 ¶ A psalm. Oh sing unto the LORD a new song; for he hath done wonderful things: his right hand and his holy arm have gotten him the victory.

2 The LORD hath made known his salvation: before the eyes of the nations hath he revealed his righteousness.

3 He hath remembered his kindness and his truth toward the house of Israel: all the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.

4 Shout joyfully unto the LORD, all the lands: break forth, and rejoice, and sing praises.

5 Sing praises unto the LORD with the harp,—with the harp, and the voice of psalmody.

6 With trumpets and the sound of cornet shout joyfully before the King, the LORD.

PSALMS XCVIII.—CII.

7 Let the sea roar, with all that filleth it; the world, with those that dwell therein.

8 Let the rivers clap their hands; let the mountains be joyful together,

9 Before the LORD; for he cometh to judge the earth: he will judge the world with righteousness, and people with equity.

PSALM XCIX.

1 ¶ The LORD reigneth; people tremble: he sitteth enthroned over the cherubim; the earth is moved.

2 The LORD is great in Zion; and he is exalted above all the people.

3 They will give thanks to thy name, great, and terrible, (and) holy it is;

4 And^a to the power of the king who loveth justice; thou hast established equity; justice and righteousness hast thou truly executed in Jacob.

5 Exalt ye the LORD our God, and bow yourselves down before his footstool: he is holy.—

6 Moses and Aaron were among his priests, and Samuel among those that call on his name; they called on the LORD, and he answered them.

7 In the pillar of cloud he used to speak unto them: they kept his testimonies, and the statutes which he had given unto them.

8 O LORD, our God, thou didst answer them: thou wast a forgiving God unto them, yet also an avenger for their wrong doings.^b

9 Exalt the LORD our God, and bow yourselves down before his holy mount; for holy is the LORD our God.

PSALM C.

1 ¶ A psalm of thanksgiving. Shout joyfully unto the LORD, all ye lands.

2 Serve the LORD with joy; come before his presence with triumphal song.

3 Know, that the LORD is God indeed: it is he that hath made us, and his are we—his people and the flock of his pasture.

^a So Rashi and other commentators, who conceive "they will give thanks" is to be understood before this verse also; thus: "And they will praise the power of the king," &c.; but Aben Ezra, "And the power is the king's, who loveth justice."

^b So Jonathan, Rashi, &c.; but Aben Ezra and Redak refer it to the rebellion of Korach, and we should then render, "and thou didst avenge the false accusations against them." But it more probably means, that even

4 Enter his gates with thanksgiving, his courts with praise: give thanks unto him, bless his name.

5 For the LORD is good; to eternity endureth his kindness; and unto the latest generation his truth.

PSALM CI.

1 ¶ By David, a psalm. Of kindness and justice will I sing: unto thee, O LORD, will I sing praises.

2 I will carefully regard the way of the perfect: oh when wilt thou come unto me? I will walk in the integrity of my heart in the midst of my house.^d

3 I will not set before my eyes a godless thing; to commit a departure (from righteousness) do I hate; it shall not cleave to me.

4 A perverse heart shall depart from me: evil will I not know.

5 Whoso slandereth in secret his neighbour, him will I destroy: whoso hath proud eyes and a haughty heart, him will I not suffer.

6 My eyes shall be upon the faithful of the land, that they may abide with me: he that walketh in the way of the perfect, he it is that shall serve me.

7 He that practiseth deceit shall not dwell within my house: he that speaketh falsehoods shall not succeed before my eyes.

8 Every morning will I destroy all the wicked of the land, cutting off from the city of the LORD all the wrong-doers.

PSALM CII.

1 ¶ A prayer of the afflicted, when he is overwhelmed, and poureth out before the LORD his complaint.

2 O LORD, hear my prayer, and let my cry come unto thee.

3 Hide not thy face from me on the day when I am distressed; incline unto me thy ear; on the day when I call, answer me speedily.

the beloved of God do not escape the punishment due to their transgressions, so even-handed is divine justice. Philippon regards this verse as applied to all Israel, not to Moses, Aaron, and Samuel.

^c So is the *Keri* *Sh*; but the *Kethib* is *Sh* "not we ourselves," we are not the architects of our own fortune. Or might it not be thus rendered as a question, "and are we not his people?" &c.

^d Rashi explains, "no less in secret than in public."

4 For my days vanish in smoke, and my bones are burning like a hearth.*

5 Struck (by heat) like the herb and dried up is my heart; for I forget to eat my bread.

6 Because of the voice of my groaning my bones cleave to my flesh.

7 I am like the pelican of the wilderness: I am become like the owl amid ruins.

8 I watch, and I am become like a (night-) bird sitting alone upon the housetop.

9 All the day my enemies reproach me: they that mock^b me swear by me.

10 For ashes do I eat like bread, and my drink I mingle with weeping;

11 Because of thy indignation and thy wrath; for thou hadst lifted me up, and hast cast me down.

12 My days are like a shadow that declineth;^c and like the herb I wither.

13 But thou, O LORD, wilt sit enthroned for ever; and thy memorial is unto all generations.

14 Thou wilt indeed arise; thou wilt have mercy upon Zion; for it is time to favour her, for the appointed time is coming.

15 For thy servants hold dear her stones, and her very dust they cherish.

16 Then shall nations fear the name of the LORD, and all the kings of the earth thy glory:

17 When the LORD shall have built up Zion, he appeareth in his glory;

18 (When) he hath regarded the prayer of the forsaken, and doth not despise their prayer.

19 This shall be written down for the latest generation; and the people which shall be created shall praise the LORD.

20 For he hath looked down from the height of his sanctuary; the LORD hath cast from heaven his view to the earth;

21 To hear the sighing of the prisoner; to loosen those that are doomed to death:

22 That men may proclaim in Zion the name of the LORD, and his praise in Jerusalem;

23 When people, are gathered together, and kingdoms, to serve the LORD.—

24 He hath weakened on the way my strength; he hath shortened my days.

25 I will say, O my God! take me not away in the midst of my days: throughout all generations are thy years.

26 In olden times didst thou lay the foundations of the earth; and the heavens are the work of thy hands.

27 These will indeed perish, but thou wilt ever exist: yea, all of them will wear out like a garment; as a vesture wilt thou change them, and they will be changed;

28 But thou art ever the same, and thy years will have no end.

29 The children of thy servants will dwell (securely), and their seed will be firmly established before thee.

PSALM CIII.

1 ¶ Of David. Bless, O my soul, the LORD, and all that is within me, his holy name.

2 Bless, O my soul, the LORD, and forget not all his benefits:

3 Who forgiveth all thy iniquities; who healeth all thy diseases;

4 Who redeemeth from the pit^d thy life; who crowneth thee with kindness and mercies;

5 Who satisfieth with happiness thy spirit,^e so that thy youth is renewed like the eagle's (plumage).^f

6 The LORD executeth righteousness, and justice for all that are oppressed.

7 He made known his ways unto Moses, unto the children of Israel his acts.

8 Merciful and gracious is the LORD, long-suffering and abundant in kindness.

9 Not for all eternity will he contend; nor will he for ever retain his anger.

10 Not in accordance with our sins hath he dealt with us; nor according to our iniquities hath he required us.

11 For as high as heaven is above the

* Mendelssohn, "are consumed as a firebrand."

^b Rashi. Redak, "who rave about me." Philippson, "who would make me a fool." "Swear by me" means that they say, "May I become like him, if I have done so."

^c Others, "lengthened," i. e. toward night; but it is the same as declining—toward extinction by the coming darkness.

^d Others, "destruction."

^e Aben Ezra. Jonathan, "old age." Lit. "ornament," which old age is to the good, and the spirit to the chief of God's creation. Redak, "mouth." (See Ps. xxxii. 9.)

^f Rashi; but Philippson conceives that it merely means that the youth spoken of should be renewed to be as vigorous as the eagle is.